Christina Youn

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Computer science education · computer systems education · computing assessment · generative AI in computing education

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
PhD in Computer Science — *Fall 2021-Present*

University of Notre Dame
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, magna cum laude — *Spring 2021*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research – Computer Science Education
Advisor: Max Fowler — *Spring 2026-Present*

- Investigating foundational knowledge and assessment in introductory computer systems education
- Designing and studying assessment approaches that make students' reasoning about code and system behavior visible
- Exploring how GenAI shapes students' programming practices, motivation, learning, and conceptions of programming competence

Graduate Research – Real-Time and AI Systems
Advisor: Tarek Abdelzaher — *Fall 2021-Fall 2025*

Undergraduate Research
Dong Wang — *Fall 2020-Spring 2021*
Christian Poellabauer — *Fall 2018-Spring 2021*

REU Summer Program
Nalini Venkatasubramanian — *Summer 2020*
Carrick Detweiler — *Summer 2019*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Head Teaching Assistant
Systems Programming — *Fall 2026*

Graduate Teaching Assistant
Systems Programming — *Spring 2024; Spring 2025-Spring 2026*
Real-time and Cyber-Physical Systems — *Fall 2024*
Distributed Systems — *Fall 2023*

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant
Operating System Principles — *Fall 2020*
Systems Programming — *Spring 2020; Spring 2021*
Fundamentals of Computing — *Fall 2019*
Introduction to Engineering Systems — *Fall 2018; Spring 2019*

PUBLICATIONS

Christina Youn, Sam Ruggerio, Eddy Jiang, and Max Fowler. "Mapping the Systems Requirements: A CS2023-Grounded Analysis of R1 University Curricula." *Proceedings of the 58th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE TS 2027)*, 2027. In press.

Joslyn Orgill, **Christina Youn**, Max Fowler, and Kathryn Cunningham. "From 'Forbidden Fruit' to 'Really Good Tool': Shifting Attitudes Toward GenAI Among Non-CS Majors." *Proceedings of the 58th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE TS 2027)*, 2027. In press.

David H. Smith IV, **Christina Youn**, and Max Fowler. "A Tale of Two Structures: Comparing Explain-in-Plain-Language and Multistructural Prompt Problems in CS1." *Proceedings of the 58th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE TS 2027)*, 2027. In press.

Joslyn Orgill, **Christina Youn**, Kathryn Cunningham, and Max Fowler. "Understanding Non-CS Majors' Motivation to Learn Programming in the Context of Generative AI." *Proceedings of the 26th Koli Calling International Conference on Computing Education Research (Koli Calling '26)*, 2026. In press.

Dachun Sun, Jinning Li, You Lyu, Xinyi Liu, **Christina Youn**, Jianyuan Zhan, and Tarek Abdelzaher. "Anatomy of Conflict: A Tool for Understanding Conflict Dynamics from Social Media Data." *International Conference on Smart Applications, Communications and Networking*, 2025.

Xinyi Liu, Ruijie Wang, Dachun Sun, Jinning Li, **Christina Youn**, You Lyu, Jianyuan Zhan, Dayou Wu, Xinhe Xu, Mingjun Liu, Xinshuo Lei, Zhihao Xu, Yutong Zhang, Zehao Li, Qikai Yang, and Tarek Abdelzaher. "Influence Pathway Discovery on Social Media." *IEEE 9th International Conference on Collaboration and Internet Computing*, 2023.

Lanyu Shang, Yang Zhang, **Christina Youn**, and Dong Wang. "SAT-Geo: A Social Sensing Based Content-Only Approach to Geolocating Abnormal Traffic Events Using Syntax-Based Probabilistic Learning." *Information Processing & Management*, 2022.

Lanyu Shang, **Christina Youn**, Yuheng Zha, Yang Zhang, and Dong Wang. "KnowMeme: A Knowledge-Enriched Graph Neural Network Solution to Offensive Meme Detection." *IEEE 17th International Conference on eScience (eScience)*, 2021.

Lanyu Shang, Yang Zhang, Yuheng Zha, Yingxi Chen, **Christina Youn**, and Dong Wang. "AOMD: An Analogy-Aware Approach to Offensive Meme Detection on Social Media." *Information Processing & Management*, 2021.

Ziyi Kou, Lanyu Shang, Yang Zhang, **Christina Youn**, and Dong Wang. "FakeSens: A Social Sensing Approach to COVID-19 Misinformation Detection on Social Media." *17th International Conference on Distributed Computing in Sensor Systems (DCOSS)*, 2021.